

Module 3 Assignment 3A:

Review and Comment on Form

Course: CS 85 - PHP Programming

Instructor: Vicky Seno

For this assignment, I reviewed and recreated a PHP “Contact Me” form script. The goal was to understand how a basic PHP form handles user input, validates fields, keeps form values after errors, and sends a message using PHP logic.

I created the file:

`public/module3a/ContactForm.php`

The form includes fields for:

Name

Email

Subject

Message

I added detailed inline comments explaining the main parts of the script, including:

```
validateInput()  
validateEmail()  
displayForm()  
$_POST form submission handling  
sticky form behavior  
mail() message handling
```

I also added a reflection section at the end of the PHP file explaining what each function does, how user input is protected, what parts were confusing, what could be improved, and why a copy of the form is sent to the sender.

I tested the form locally and confirmed that invalid input shows validation messages while keeping the submitted values in the form. I also improved the form by safely displaying user input with `htmlspecialchars()` to reduce the risk of XSS when sticky values are shown again.

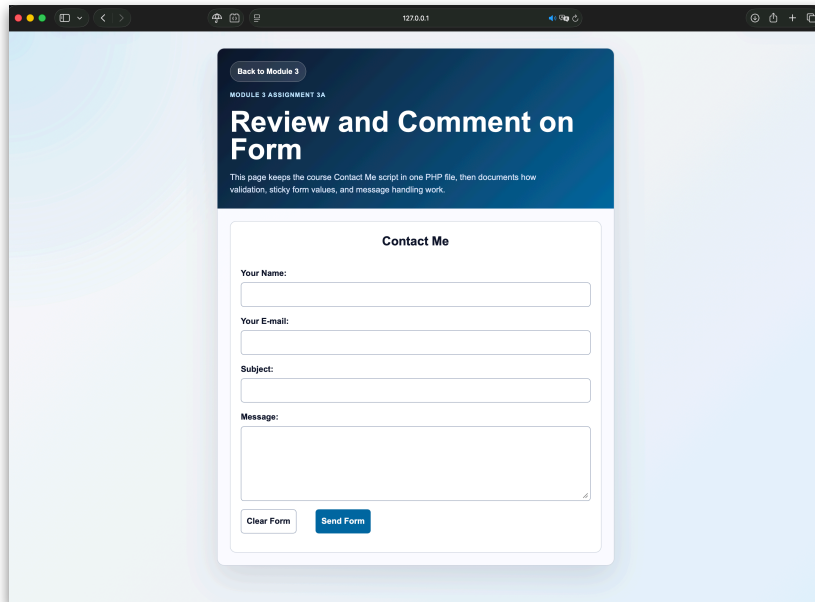
Local test URL:

<http://127.0.0.1:8000/module3a/ContactForm.php>

GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/sergehall/cs85-php-programming/blob/main/public/module3a/ContactForm.php>

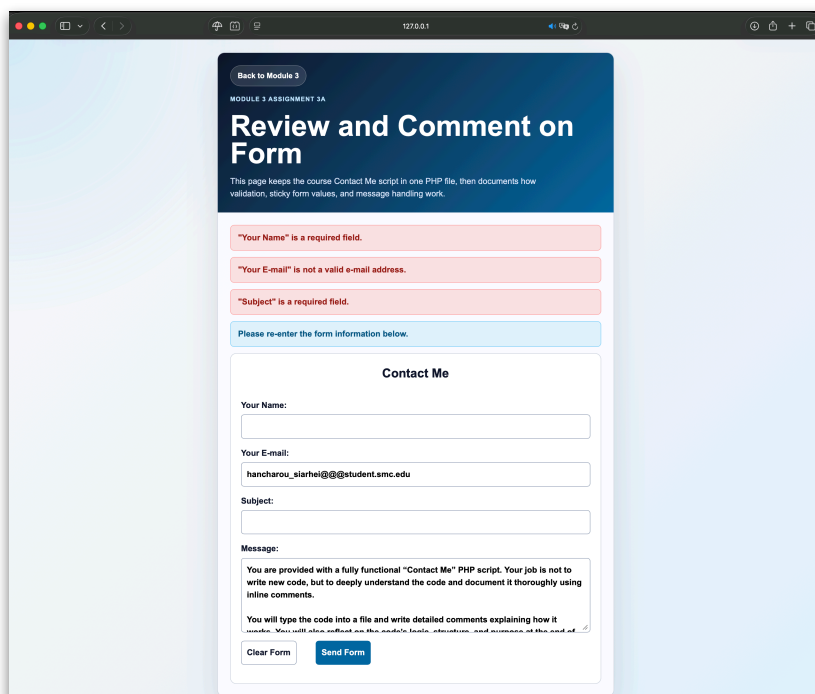
Screenshots included:

- Contact form page



A screenshot of a web browser displaying a page titled "Review and Comment on Form". The page has a dark blue header with a "Back to Module 3" link and the text "MODULE 3 ASSIGNMENT 3A". Below the header, there is a white box titled "Contact Me" containing a form with fields for "Your Name:", "Your E-mail:", "Subject:", and "Message:". At the bottom of the form are "Clear Form" and "Send Form" buttons. The page also includes a paragraph of text explaining the purpose of the page.

- Invalid input validation and sticky form values after error



A screenshot of the same web browser displaying the "Review and Comment on Form" page. This time, the "Contact Me" form has validation errors. Red error messages are displayed above the form fields: "Your Name" is a required field, "Your E-mail" is not a valid e-mail address, and "Subject" is a required field. A blue message box states "Please re-enter the form information below." The form fields are pre-filled with the values from the previous attempt: "Your Name" is empty, "Your E-mail" is "hancharou_siarhei@student.smc.edu", and "Subject" is empty. The "Message" field contains a paragraph of text. The "Clear Form" and "Send Form" buttons are still present at the bottom of the form.

- Code/comments in ContactForm.php

```

() package.json  ContactForm.php X
public > module3a > ContactForm.php
255 {
256   <div class="form-card">
257     <h2 class="form-title">Contact Me</h2>
258     <form name="contact" action="ContactForm.php" method="post">
259       <p>
260         <label>
261           Your Name:
262           <!-- The value attribute reuses the submitted name after a failed validation attempt. -->
263           <input type="text" name="Sender" value="<?php echo $safeSender; ?>" />
264         </label>
265       </p>
266       <p>
267         <label>
268           Your E-mail:
269           <!-- The e-mail field is sticky too, but it is validated by validateEmail(). -->
270           <input type="text" name="Email" value="<?php echo $safeEmail; ?>" />
271         </label>
272       </p>
273       <p>
274         <label>
275           Subject:
276           <!-- Subject is handled as regular text input by validateInput(). -->
277           <input type="text" name="Subject" value="<?php echo $safeSubject; ?>" />
278         </label>
279       </p>
280       <p>
281         <label>
282           Message:<br />
283           <!-- Textarea content is placed between the opening and closing tags. -->
284           <textarea name="Message"><?php echo $safeMessage; ?></textarea>
285         </label>
286       </p>
287       <p class="actions">
288         <!-- Reset clears the visible browser form fields without submitting the form. -->
289         <input class="button-secondary" type="reset" value="Clear Form" />&nbsp;&nbsp;&
290
291         <!-- This button creates $_POST['Submit'], which the PHP script checks below. -->
292         <input class="button" type="submit" name="Submit" value="Send Form" />
293       </p>
294     </form>
295   </div>
296 }

```

PROBLEMS OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS

```

* Executing task: npm run dev-local
[laravel] 2026-06-29 17:13:21 /roadmap/module-3 ..... ~ 0.05ms
[laravel] 2026-06-29 17:13:21 /manifest.webmanifest ..... ~ 0.20ms
[laravel] 2026-06-29 17:13:21 /assets/brand/cs85-logo-192.png ..... ~ 0.30ms
[laravel] 2026-06-29 17:13:23 /module3a/ContactForm.php ..... ~ 0.10ms
[laravel] 127.0.0.1:51660 [200]: POST /module3a/ContactForm.php
[laravel] 2026-06-29 17:17:56 ..... ~ 0.24ms
[laravel] 127.0.0.1:51661 [200]: POST /module3a/ContactForm.php

```